



Sweet potatoes deserve more love than they get. They replenish glycogen efficiently, carry beta-carotene for tissue repair, and sit kindly in the gut. Roast a tray on Sunday and you have training-day carbs sorted for the week.

Eggs remain one of the most bioavailable protein sources on the planet. Two whole eggs plus two whites post-session give you leucine, choline, and healthy fats in one cheap package.

Greek yoghurt or hung curd is my go-to snack for athletes struggling to hit protein targets.

Mix in some jaggery and almonds and you have a recovery bowl that tastes like dessert.

Bananas are the original sports food. Potassium for cramp prevention, fast carbs for mid-session fuelling, and a digestive profile gentle enough for training.

Ragi, particularly in South Indian kitchens, is criminally underused by endurance athletes. Calcium, iron, and complex carbohydrates in one ancient grain. A ragi dosa for breakfast is functional nutrition in disguise.

Dal and rice together create a

complete amino acid profile at a fraction of the cost of imported supplements. This combination has fuelled Indian wrestlers for generations. It can fuel you through HYROX.

Fatty fish like mackerel or sardines deliver Omega-3 fatty acids that reduce training-induced inflammation.

Two servings per week measurably improve recovery markers. Vegetarians can get some benefit from flaxseed and walnuts, though the conversion rate is lower.

Leafy greens, particularly *palak* and *methi*, provide nitrates that improve exercise economy. Beetroot does this too, and if you can tolerate beetroot juice 90 minutes before training, the research on performance benefits is genuinely impressive.

Dark chocolate, 70 per cent or higher, is the reward food that actually works. Flavanols improve blood flow, magnesium supports muscle function, and the psychological lift of earning a square of good chocolate after a hard session should not be underestimated.

Ultimate test: HYROX is a global indoor fitness race that combines eight kilometres of running with eight standardised functional workout stations like sled pushes, rowing, and wall balls. GETTY IMAGES

What to avoid

Deep-fried food the day before a session. Alcohol during training blocks, because it wrecks sleep quality and protein synthesis.

Ultra-processed protein bars masquerading as clean fuel. New supplements introduced within four weeks of race day. And please, do not carb-load like a marathoner the night before a HYROX. The event is too short and too mixed to justify it. You will feel sluggish off the start line.

The HYROX calendar is only going to get busier. More events are already announced for 2027, and organisations are launching similar competitions across India. The opportunity to become a genuine fitness athlete has never been better. But the shortcut does not exist. Train patiently, eat intentionally, respect the event, and your next HYROX will reward you.